

4.6 ASSESSMENT OF WRITTEN COMMUNICATION AND ICT

Candidates are expected to:

- Present relevant information in a form that suits its purpose.
- Ensure text is legible and that spelling, punctuation and grammar are accurate, so that meaning is clear.

Where appropriate they should also use a suitable structure and style of writing.

Each question paper will be marked out of 100 marks, four of which will be awarded for the Quality of Written Communication (QoWC). These marks will be attached to all four of the assessment objectives.

Candidates will be awarded marks on two separate occasions, within each question paper, for the quality of their written communication, according to the following criteria:

Ideas are expressed clearly, fluently, legibly and in an appropriate way. There are few errors in spelling, punctuation and grammar.	2 marks
Straightforward ideas are expressed relatively clearly, legibly and appropriately. There may be some errors of spelling, punctuation and grammar, but these do not obscure the meaning of the answer.	1 mark
Candidate fails to reach the threshold standard in all respects.	0 marks

The questions where QoWC marks are to be awarded will be marked with an asterisk. The criteria above will appear in the mark scheme for each of these questions.

This specification will allow candidates to develop their ability to use ICT. There are opportunities throughout the specification for candidates to research information, share information, analyse collected data, present information and to review, modify and evaluate their work. The specification provides, for example, such opportunities through a study of a business working within the competitive market; an examination of the impact of the Budget on government income and spending; and the trading patterns of the UK economy.

The Case Study papers (Papers 2 and 4) will be based on a pre-released case study, which will be available to candidates approximately six months before the examination. Candidates will be encouraged to use the internet and other electronic sources when conducting research to enhance their knowledge and understanding of the Case Study scenario. It is intended that a list of useful and relevant websites to support this research will be published at the same time as the case study is released to Centres.

ICT will not be specifically assessed in this specification, but opportunities to utilise ICT and opportunities for the assessment of the IT Key Skill will be signposted throughout the specification.